

SEE SHARP



Illustration: Mahesh Benkar

If you, like Microsoft, believe that .Net is going to change the face of computing, get a certification in this platform and join the revolution

MANU KHANNA

The last time Microsoft did something from 'scratch' was in 1990 when it launched a new 'ghost' operating system which, unlike its predecessors (the DOS family), could be operated by a device called the 'mouse'. This ghost OS was Windows 3.0. Since then, Microsoft has just been improving (still improving!) its OS by adding more features to make it more user-friendly.

Finally, 11 years later, Microsoft has launched .Net, which, if all goes well, is going to change the way computer users go about their work. Simply put, .Net is a new operating system platform that aims to take users to the next generation of the Internet. It plans to do so by conquering the deficiencies of the first generation, which is the present-day Net, and by giving users a more enriched

experience when they work with the Web for both personal and business applications.

The story so far

Necessity is the mother of invention, and so it is in this case. .Net is an invention that was fuelled by the idea of making distributed computing the next 'Giant Leap in Technology' after the Internet.

In the distributed computing model, components and objects belonging to one application can be located on different computers as long as they are connected via LAN or over the Internet. For example, a spreadsheet application could have the Main Editor on one computer in India, an Organisational Chart Object on a second computer in the US and a Standard Deviation Object on a third machine in England. Sure, that

